team. He never gave directions. Rather, through a free exchange
of views, he led us forward into new terrain which often revealed an unforeseen solution. Perhaps he was aware that though a particular goal might be clear to himself, and he could give adequate directions for its accomplishment, his team members might have resisted working towards a goal that made no sense to them. He considered the col ective understanding of the problem the main attribute of effective leadership. He once told me, “Look, my job is to make decisions; but it is equal y important to see to it that these decisions are accepted by my team members.”

In fact, Prof. Sarabhai took a series of decisions that were to become the life-mission of many. We would make our own rockets, our own Satel ite Launch Vehicles (SLVs) and our own satel ites. And this would not be done one-by-one but concurrently, in a multi-dimensional fashion. In the development of payloads for the sounding rockets, instead of getting a certain payload and then engineering it to fit into the rocket, we discussed the matter threadbare with the payload scientists working in different organ-izations and at different locations. I may even say that the most